DEFENCE JOURNEY

NDA Current Affairs Notes

Static background, defence facts and a daily method for the NDA

GAT paper

NDA | CURRENT AFFAIRS

Current Affairs carries about 10 questions in the NDA GAT paper. Questions come from the last 12 months of news, plus static facts about defence, government schemes, international organisations, awards and sports. These notes give you the **stable background facts** and a method to follow daily news. They do not list the latest events, because news changes every week. Fill the 'Latest' sections yourself from a newspaper and the sources given below.

REMEMBER: Any name of a minister, chief, champion or award winner changes with time. Before the exam, check each such fact against a current newspaper or official website.

1. How to Prepare Current Affairs

- Read one national newspaper (The Hindu or Indian Express) for 30 minutes daily. Focus on the national, international, economy, science and sports pages.
- Use the **PIB** website (pib.gov.in) for government decisions and **Defence** news from the Ministry of Defence.
- Keep a notebook with five headings: Defence, National, International, Science and Technology, Sports and Awards. Write one line per item.
- Every week, revise the notes. Every month, make a one-page summary.
- For each event, remember **who, what, where, when**. Questions often ask about places in the news (use a map), persons in new positions, and new schemes.
- Focus on the last 12 months before the exam date.

2. Indian Armed Forces: Static Facts

Item	Fact
Supreme Commander	The President of India.
Three services	Indian Army, Indian Navy, Indian Air Force. Coast Guard is under the Ministry of Defence.
Service chiefs	Chief of the Army Staff (COAS), Chief of the Naval Staff, Chief of the Air Staff. The **Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)** post was created in 2019; General Bipin Rawat was the first CDS.
Army Day	15 January (Field Marshal K. M. Cariappa became the first Indian Commander-in-Chief in 1949).
Navy Day	4 December. Air Force Day: 8 October.
Field Marshals	Sam Manekshaw (1973) and K. M. Cariappa (1986). Marshal of the Air Force: Arjan Singh.
Commands	Army has 7 commands (e.g. Northern, Western, Eastern, Southern, Central, South Western and the training command ARTRAC). Navy: Western (Mumbai), Eastern (Visakhapatnam), Southern (Kochi). Air Force: 7 commands. There are also tri-service commands: Andaman and Nicobar Command, and Strategic Forces Command.
Gallantry awards	Param Vir Chakra (highest wartime), Maha Vir Chakra, Vir Chakra; Ashoka Chakra (highest peacetime), Kirti Chakra, Shaurya Chakra.
Training academies	NDA (Khadakwasla, Pune), IMA (Dehradun), Officers Training Academy (Chennai), Indian Naval Academy (Ezhimala, Kerala), Air Force Academy (Dundigal, Hyderabad).
Aircraft carrier	INS Vikrant (indigenous, commissioned 2022) and INS Vikramaditya.
Major exercises	Malabar (India, USA, Japan, Australia), Yudh Abhyas (India and USA), Garuda (with France), Ajeya Warrior (with UK), Cope India (with USA).
Defence organisations	DRDO (research), HAL (aircraft, Tejas light combat aircraft), BEL, Mazagon Dock, Ordnance Factories (now corporatised). Atmanirbhar Bharat promotes indigenous defence production.
Wars	1947-48 (Kashmir), 1962 (China), 1965 (Pakistan), 1971 (Bangladesh liberation, Vijay Diwas on 16 December), 1999 (Kargil, Kargil Vijay Diwas on 26 July).

3. Government and Schemes: Background

- **NITI Aayog** replaced the Planning Commission (2015). The Prime Minister is its chairperson.
- Goods and Services Tax (GST) was launched on 1 July 2017.
- Examples of long-running schemes: Digital India, Make in India, Swachh Bharat Mission, Jan Dhan Yojana (bank accounts), Ayushman Bharat (health insurance), Skill India, Startup India, PM Kisan, Ujjwala Yojana (LPG), and Atmanirbhar Bharat. Learn the purpose of each.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is the central bank (formed 1935, HQ Mumbai). SEBI regulates the stock market. Currency: Rupee.
- The Union Budget is presented by the Finance Minister, usually on 1 February. The financial year is 1 April to 31 March.
- Election Commission of India conducts elections; the Census is conducted every 10 years.

- India's capital: New Delhi. Currency symbol: ₹. National symbols: Tiger (animal), Peacock (bird), Lotus (flower), Banyan (tree), Mango (fruit), Ganga (river), Hockey (often called the national game, though India has no officially declared national sport).

4. International Organisations

Organisation	HQ	Facts
United Nations (UN)	New York	Founded 24 October 1945. Secretary-General heads it. Security Council has 5 permanent members (USA, UK, France, Russia, China) and 10 non-permanent members.
WHO	Geneva	Health agency of the UN.
UNESCO	Paris	Education, science and culture. Declares World Heritage Sites.
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	Washington D.C.	Financial stability and loans.
World Bank	Washington D.C.	Development finance.
World Trade Organization (WTO)	Geneva	Global trade rules.
NATO	Brussels	Military alliance formed in 1949.
BRICS	-	Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa (and new members since 2024).
SAARC	Kathmandu	South Asia group formed in 1985.
ASEAN	Jakarta	10 Southeast Asian countries.
Quad	-	India, USA, Japan and Australia.
G20	-	Group of major economies. India hosted the 2023 summit in New Delhi.
International Court of Justice	The Hague	Main judicial organ of the UN.
International Red Cross	Geneva	Humanitarian relief.

5. Awards and Honours (How They Work)

Award	Details
Bharat Ratna	Highest civilian award of India. Others: Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan, Padma Shri. Announced around Republic Day.
Nobel Prize	Given in Physics, Chemistry, Medicine, Literature, Peace and Economics. Announced in October. Peace Prize given in Oslo, others in Stockholm.
Jnanpith	Highest literary award in India.
Dadasaheb Phalke Award	Highest award in Indian cinema.
Arjuna Award	For sportspersons. Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna is the highest sports honour. Dronacharya Award is for coaches.
Gallantry	Param Vir Chakra, Ashoka Chakra, etc. (see above).

6. Sports Facts

- Olympic Games: held every 4 years. Five rings represent five continents. Motto: Citius, Altius, Fortius (Faster, Higher, Stronger). India's individual gold medallists include Abhinav Bindra (Beijing 2008, shooting) and Neeraj Chopra (Tokyo 2020, javelin).
- Cricket: ICC Cricket World Cup. India won in 1983 (Kapil Dev), 2011 (M. S. Dhoni) and the T20 World Cup in 2007 and 2024.
- Hockey: India has won 8 Olympic gold medals in men's field hockey.
- Grand Slam tennis tournaments: Australian Open, French Open, Wimbledon, US Open.
- National sports bodies and venues: Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium (Delhi). Khelo India promotes youth sports.
- Number of players: cricket 11, football 11, hockey 11, volleyball 6, basketball 5, kabaddi 7.

7. Important Days

Date	Day	Date	Day
26 January	Republic Day	15 August	Independence Day
2 October	Gandhi Jayanti	14 November	Children's Day
5 September	Teachers' Day	24 January	National Girl Child Day
1 December	World AIDS Day	10 December	Human Rights Day
21 June	International Yoga Day	8 March	International Women's Day
5 June	World Environment Day	1 May	Labour Day
7 April	World Health Day	24 October	United Nations Day
23 January	Netaji's birth anniversary	31 October	National Unity Day (Sardar Patel)
15 October	Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam's birth anniversary	11 May	National Technology Day

8. My Weekly Revision Sheet

Fill this sheet every week from the newspaper. Make 5 to 8 entries in each row, and revise it before the exam.

Topic	What to write
Defence news	New equipment, exercises, appointments, operations
National	New laws, schemes, elections, projects, summits
International	Visits, agreements, conflicts, new leaders, summits
Science and tech	Space missions, new technology, medical news
Sports	Tournament winners, records, hosts
Awards and appointments	New winners, new heads of organisations
Places in the news	Mark on the map and write why